

10.3 Organisation

Investigations must be linked to the content of the course, and have the potential to allow students to meet all the assessment criteria given on page 92.

There are a number of suggested topics for investigation, and students can select one of these. (For further information, please see *Further resources* on page 151.) However, the choice should not be restricted to these topics. Students may wish to suggest their own topics for investigation.

Students must produce individual work. Two or more students may choose the same or similar topics, provided each works independently.

Normally laboratory or field work will be undertaken under the direct supervision of the teacher. If the nature of the investigation involves a student carrying out practical work outside the school or college environment, sufficient work must take place under direct supervision to allow the teacher to ensure that it is the student's own work. The teacher must discuss the practical aspects with the student to establish that the student did undertake the work personally. This might be done by asking about precise details of the work, the apparatus used, the practical problems encountered and how they were overcome.